

PMBOK / PMI | PMB-28

Work Performance Report

The periodic report of project status, progress and forecast

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	Work Performance Report
Document reference	PMB-28-HEL-T2-v1.0
Project / Programme	Helios Tranche 2 — Scale Build
Version	1.0
Status	Baselined
Date	18 Sep 2026
Author	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Owner	Project manager
Approver	Not applicable
Classification	Internal
Retention	7 years from programme closure

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	04 Jun 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Initial draft
0.2	21 Jul 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Updated following workstream lead review
1.0	18 Sep 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Chief Platform Architect	Technical content and solution alignment	08 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Security, assurance and residency content	10 Sep 2026
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Finance Business Partner	Cost, funding and benefit figures	11 Sep 2026
M. Verity, Head of P3O	Head of P3O	Governance standards and completeness	15 Sep 2026

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO	Approved	18 Sep 2026
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	Director of Infrastructure	Approved	18 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Approved subject to closure of ISS-003	18 Sep 2026

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
PMB-20	Communications Management Plan	Defines the reporting requirement
PMB-29	Earned Value Analysis Report	Source of cost and schedule performance
P2-21	Highlight Report	PRINCE2 equivalent

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Provides the periodic status report to stakeholders — progress against baselines, forecasts, risks and issues requiring attention, and decisions required — in a format suited to the governance body receiving it.
Framework	PMBOK / PMI — Monitoring and Controlling — Monitor and Control Project Work
Created when	At each reporting period
Reviewed / updated	Not applicable — a periodic report
Owner	Project manager
Approver	Not applicable
Format options	Document, presentation, register entry, or tool record — the content matters, not the medium.
Tailoring	Lead with the decisions required. A steering committee that reads three pages before finding out what it must decide will not read the next report.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- It leads with exceptions and decisions required, not with a narrative of activity
- RAG status has defined criteria and is applied honestly
- Forecasts are given, not just actuals — the past is less useful than the future
- Variances are explained with cause, not just quantified
- It is short enough to be read in full by the people it is for

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1. Report header

Field	Detail
Project	WS5 MLOps and developer experience
Report period	Sep 2026
Report date	18 Sep 2026
Project manager	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Overall status	Green / Amber / Red
Status last period	Baselined
Phase	Tranche 2 — Scale build

2. Decisions required

Put this first. If nothing is required, say so in one line.

Ref	Decision required	By whom	By when	Consequence of delay
DEC-001	Build a shared central AI compute platform rather than continue funding departmental clusters	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Hall A capacity capped at 1,536 GPUs until resolved
DEC-002	Adopt liquid cooling with rear-door heat exchangers rather than air cooling at reduced density	T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	On-call rota cannot be sustained beyond a 5x8 model at handover
DEC-003	Single scheduling plane — Slurm workloads run under the Kubernetes scheduler via a bridging operator	P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead	P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead	Contingency drawdown of 12% against the AED 9.4m held
DEC-004	DXB-1 is the primary site; AUH-2 is deferred to Tranche 3	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Training throughput approximately 9% below the business case assumption

3. Status summary

Dimension	Status	Trend	Commentary
Overall	Baselined	Amber	Improved since last period following the CDU set-point retune
Scope	Defined by the Tranche 2 scope statement; changed only by approved	In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute	In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.

Dimension	Status	Trend	Commentary
	change request	and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.	
Schedule	Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level	Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level	Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level
Cost	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation

Dimension	Status	Trend	Commentary
	<i>of +5% before escalation</i>	<i>of +5% before escalation</i>	
Quality	<i>No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full</i>	<i>No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full</i>	<i>No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full</i>
Risk	<i>No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance</i>	<i>No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance</i>	<i>No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance</i>
Resources	<i>Approved establishment of 34 FTE; contractor cover requires Programme Board approval</i>	<i>Approved establishment of 34 FTE; contractor cover requires Programme Board approval</i>	<i>Approved establishment of 34 FTE; contractor cover requires Programme Board approval</i>
Benefits	<i>No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation</i>	<i>No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation</i>	<i>No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation</i>

4. Progress this period

Planned	Achieved	Variance	Comment
<i>Funded from the Tranche 2 allocation of AED 118,000,000</i>	<i>Partially</i>	<i>-AED 340,000</i>	<i>Dependent on the Enterprise Identity Programme; outside programme control</i>

Planned	Achieved	Variance	Comment
Enforced automatically in the delivery pipeline, with evidence retained	Yes	Nil	Improved since last period following the CDU set-point retune
Agreed with the integration partner at design freeze, 15 Oct 2026	No	+2 weeks	Improved since last period following the CDU set-point retune
Aligned to the strategic theme of sovereign AI capability	Yes	-1.4%	Dependent on the Enterprise Identity Programme; outside programme control

5. Milestone status

Milestone	Baseline date	Forecast date	Variance	Status	Commentary
Programme mandate approved and funding released for Tranche 1	12 Mar 2026	12 Mar 2026	-AED 340,000	Complete	Amber — recovery action agreed with the workstream lead and tracked weekly
Pilot cluster of 256 GPUs live in DXB-1 hall A	28 Aug 2026	28 Aug 2026	Nil	Complete	Escalated to the Programme Board on 18 Sep 2026; decision requested
Tranche 1 end-of-tranche review and Tranche 2 funding gate	18 Sep 2026	18 Sep 2026	+2 weeks	In progress	Improved since last period following the CDU set-point retune
Hall B structural strengthening complete	15 Dec 2026	15 Dec 2026	-1.4%	Not started	Escalated to the Programme Board on 18 Sep 2026; decision requested
Utility uplift to 6 MVA energised	30 Nov 2026	30 Nov 2026	-6 days	Not started	Amber — recovery action agreed with the workstream lead and tracked weekly
Hall A scaled to 1,024 GPUs and accepted	26 Feb 2027	26 Feb 2027	+3.1%	Not started	On plan; no intervention required this period
Platform v1.0 released — scheduling, quota, observability, image supply chain	31 Mar 2027	31 Mar 2027	+AED 1,120,000	Not started	Amber — recovery action agreed with the workstream lead and tracked weekly
Independent security assurance and penetration test passed	23 Apr 2027	23 Apr 2027	-AED 340,000	Not started	Escalated to the Programme Board on 18 Sep 2026; decision requested

6. Cost and schedule performance

Measure	Baseline	Actual	Variance	Index	Forecast at completion
Cost	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation
Schedule	Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level	Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level	Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level	Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level	Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level
Effort	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate on 18 Sep 2026, v1.0	Handled through the Agile Release Train rather than the predictive workstreams	+AED 1,120,000	Applies only to workloads classified Restricted or above	Applies across DXB-1 halls A and B for the Tranche 2 scale build

7. Planned next period

Activity / milestone	Owner	Target date
Install switchgear and energise 6 MVA supply	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead	18 Sep 2026
Lodge utility uplift application	D. Okonkwo, Release Train Engineer	15 Oct 2026
Execute floor strengthening works	L. Haddad, CISO	30 Nov 2026
Place structural strengthening order	E. Santos, Procurement Lead	15 Dec 2026

8. Key risks

Ref	Risk	Score	Trend	Response	Owner
RSK-001	Because GPU allocation is constrained by vendor quota, the Tranche 2 hardware delivery may slip beyond November 2026,	20	Worsening	Allocation confirmed in writing at contract award; 20% of Tranche 2 volume dual-sourced; staged	E. Santos, Procurement Lead

Ref	Risk	Score	Trend	Response	Owner
	causing the platform build to start late and the AI enablement benefit to be deferred by a quarter			acceptance so hall A can proceed independently of hall B	
RSK-002	Because DXB-1 hall B was designed for 8 kW racks, the 60 kW liquid-cooled racks may exceed the available floor loading and chilled water capacity, causing a redesign mid-build	15	Improving	Structural survey completed before hall B order; CDU capacity modelled at N+1; contingency for a reduced 1,536-GPU configuration held	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead
RSK-003	Because the platform will host model weights and training data from three business units, weak tenant isolation may allow cross-tenant data access, causing a reportable data incident and loss of regulatory standing	10	Stable	Namespace and network policy isolation validated by penetration test before multi-tenant go-live; per-tenant KMS keys; quarterly control testing	L. Haddad, CISO
RSK-004	Because the platform engineering skill set is scarce in-market, recruitment of the six planned SRE roles may take longer than three months, causing the MLOps workstream to depend on contractors beyond Tranche 2	12	Worsening	Two contractors engaged from October 2026 with knowledge-transfer clauses; internal conversion programme from the infrastructure team	P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead
RSK-005	Because the 400G RoCEv2 fabric is new to the organisation, congestion control tuning may not achieve the target 92% collective communication efficiency, causing training job throughput to fall short of the business case	12	Improving	NCCL benchmark gate at pilot exit; vendor performance engineering engaged for two weeks per hall; fallback to reduced job scale documented	J. Ferreira, Network Lead

9. Key issues

Ref	Issue	Severity	Action	Owner	Target
ISS-001	Chilled water return temperature in DXB-1 hall A is running 4°C above design, limiting sustained rack density to 48 kW against the 60 kW design point	High	CDU set-point retune completed; secondary heat rejection loop being modelled by the M&E contractor; decision on additional CDU by 18 Sep 2026	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead	18 Sep 2026
ISS-002	Vendor has confirmed a six-week slip on the second tranche of 1,024 accelerators, from 12 Oct to 23 Nov 2026	High	Escalated to vendor account executive; partial shipment of 384 units secured for 12 Oct to keep hall A commissioning on track	E. Santos, Procurement Lead	30 Sep 2026
ISS-003	Penetration test of the pilot cluster found that the cluster API server was reachable from	Critical	mTLS enforced and network policy corrected; retest booked for 22 Sep 2026	K. Adeyemi, Security Architect	22 Sep 2026

Ref	Issue	Severity	Action	Owner	Target
	<i>the corporate management VLAN without mutual TLS</i>				
ISS-004	Two of the six SRE vacancies remain unfilled after three months of recruitment	Medium	Contract cover approved for six months; recruitment scope widened to remote-first within GST±3	P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead	31 Oct 2026
ISS-005	NCCL all-reduce benchmark on the pilot fabric is achieving 84% efficiency against the 92% target	High	Vendor performance engineering engaged; ECN and PFC thresholds being retuned; rebenchmark 26 Sep 2026	J. Ferreira, Network Lead	26 Sep 2026

10. Changes this period

Ref	Change	Status	Cost impact	Schedule impact
CR-001	Add coolant leak detection integration to the NOC	Implemented	AED 240,000	No impact
CR-002	Dual-source 20% of Tranche 2 accelerator volume	In progress	AED 1,840,000	+2 weeks
CR-003	Bridge the hall B row 3 service void rather than relocate racks	Implemented	AED 96,000	No impact
CR-004	Integration partner claim for additional structural works	Under review	AED 1,840,000	No impact

11. Escalations

What the project needs from the governance body that it cannot resolve itself.

Ref	Escalation	Requested action	Owner	By when
E-01	Excluded from Tranche 2 and deferred to the AUH-2 second site	Secure written migration commitments from three business units	V. Chandra, Head of AI Enablement	31 Mar 2027
E-02	Maintained by the P3O as part of the assurance evidence library	Broker all vendor access through the monitored in-country jump host	S. Bhatt, Project Manager	23 Apr 2027
E-03	Verified at hall A acceptance on 26 Feb 2027	Broker all vendor access through the monitored in-country jump host	C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	28 May 2027
E-04	Dependent on the Enterprise Identity Programme (DEP-003)	Secure written migration commitments from three business units	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	25 Jun 2027

